



△ Saab Fairchild SF340 1987

Origin Sweden/USA

Engine 2 x 1,750 hp General Electric CT7-9B turboprop

Top speed 288 mph (463 km/h)

Originally a joint venture between Fairchild and Saab, the 340 was designed as a commuter airliner but is also operated as a VIP transport, maritime patrol, and airborne early warning (AEW) aircraft by four different air forces.



△ Shorts 360 1987

Origin UK

Engine 2 x 1,424 hp Pratt & Whitney Canada PT6A turboprop

Top speed 280 mph (450 km/h)

Derived from the earlier, slightly smaller 330, with which it shares many features, the 360 is notable for being extremely quiet. While it is not the fastest turboprop, this rugged aircraft is popular because it can be operated from relatively small airfields.



△ ATR 72-500 1988

Origin France/Italy

Engine 2 x 2,475 hp Pratt & Whitney PW127F turboprop

Top speed 318 mph (511 km/h)

Essentially a stretched ATR 42, around 400 ATR 72s are in service. An interesting feature is that it does not have an auxiliary power unit (APU). Instead, the starboard propeller is fitted with a brake, so the engine can be left running when the aircraft is on the ground to supply power to its systems.



△ McDonnell Douglas MD-88 1988

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 18,500 lb (8,381 kg) Pratt & Whitney JT8-D turbofan

Top speed 504 mph (811 km/h)

Essentially a "Second-Generation" DC-9, the MD-88 was the last of the MD-80 line to enter production. The principal difference over earlier models was its electronic flight instrument system. The first one was delivered to Delta Airlines in 1987 and production ended 10 years later.



△ Antonov An-225 1988

Origin USSR

Engine 6 x 51,600 lb (23,375 kg) thrust ZMKB Progress D-18 turbofan

Top speed 528 mph (850 km/h)

Designed to carry the Buran space shuttle, the An-225 is a giant six-engine strategic transporter that can carry up to 551,156 lb (250,000 kg) internally. Only one was ever finished—it flies with Antonov Airlines and specializes in carrying oversize freight.



▷ Airbus A320 1988

Origin Multinational

Engine 2 x 27,000 lb (12,231 kg) thrust CFM-56 turbofan

Top speed 537 mph (864 km/h)

Notable for being the first airliner to feature digital fly-by-wire flight controls and side-sticks, the A320 has recorded phenomenal sales since its introduction in 1988.



◁ Fairchild SA227-AC Metro III 1988

Origin USA

Engine 2 x 1,000 hp Garrett TPE331 turboprop with water injection

Top speed 355 mph (572 km/h)

The Metro evolved from the Swearingen Merlin turboprop business aircraft. Originally designed with 19 passenger seats (the maximum allowed by the FAA for operations without a flight attendant), it proved popular with regional airlines and many air forces. The USAF alone ordered more than 50.

